

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
FOR

HOUSE BILL NO. 3025

By: Lowe

COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

An Act relating to schools; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 1-117, as amended by Section 1, Chapter 285, O.S.L. 2025 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 1-117), which relates to general fund expenditures; precluding school gift, grant, or donation monies received from being calculated in the general fund carryover for a certain time period; and providing an effective date.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 1-117, as amended by Section 1, Chapter 285, O.S.L. 2025 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 1-117), is amended to read as follows:

Section 1-117. A. The general fund of any school district is hereby defined as a current expense fund and shall consist of all revenue or monies that can legally be expended within a certain specified fiscal year, but shall not be considered as including any money derived from a special building fund levy made in accordance with the provisions of Section 10 of Article X of the Oklahoma Constitution, nor shall it include any monies derived from the sale

1 of bonds issued under the provisions of Section 26 of Article X of
2 the Oklahoma Constitution. All monies derived from the proceeds of
3 the school levies made pursuant to the provisions of Section 9 of
4 Article X of the Oklahoma Constitution shall be placed in the
5 general fund provided by this section. Expenditures from the
6 general fund shall be noncapital in nature. All monies derived from
7 state-dedicated revenue, state-appropriated revenue unless otherwise
8 provided for by law, and county sources shall be placed in the
9 general fund provided for by this section. Except as provided for
10 in subsections F, K, and L of this section, a district shall not be
11 authorized to make capital expenditures as defined by this section
12 from the general fund.

13 B. For purposes of this section, state-dedicated revenue shall
14 be any registration or license fees, taxes, or penalties collected
15 at the state level and distributed to common school districts.
16 County sources shall be all funds collected by the county and
17 distributed to common school districts but shall not include any
18 funds derived from the building fund levy made in accordance with
19 the provisions of Section 10 of Article X of the Oklahoma
20 Constitution or funds derived from the sinking fund levy made in
21 accordance with the provisions of Section 26 of Article X of the
22 Oklahoma Constitution.

23 C. For the purposes of this section, a capital expenditure
24 shall be an expenditure which results in the acquisition of fixed

1 assets or additions to fixed assets. Capital expenditures shall
2 include, but shall not be limited to, purchases of land or existing
3 buildings, purchases of real property, improvements of grounds and
4 sites for construction purposes, all expenditures for construction
5 of buildings unless authorized by the State Board of Education or
6 the State Board of Career and Technology Education upon application
7 to the appropriate state board pursuant to subsection F of this
8 section, additions to buildings, remodeling of buildings if such
9 remodeling involves changes to roof structures or load-bearing
10 walls, professional services, salaries and expenses of architects
11 and engineers hired or assigned to capital projects except for such
12 services, salaries, and expenses as are applicable in preparation
13 for a bond issue, expenditures for the initial installation and
14 extension of service systems and built-in heat or air equipment to
15 existing buildings, expenditures for the replacement of a building
16 which has been destroyed, installments and lease payments on
17 property including interest that have a terminal date and result in
18 the acquisition of property, and expenditures for preliminary
19 studies made prior to the time that authority to proceed with a
20 construction project is given if authority is received within the
21 same fiscal year that the expenditure was made.

22 D. Noncapital expenditures shall include, but shall not be
23 limited to, expenditures for maintenance, repair, and replacement of
24 property and equipment, initial or additional purchases of furniture

1 and equipment, direct expenses for maintenance of plant including
2 grounds, salaries for maintenance of plant including salaries for
3 the upkeep of grounds, and repair and replacement of building
4 structures which do not add to existing facilities and which do not
5 involve changes in roof structures or load-bearing walls and which
6 are not classified as a capital expenditure by this section.

7 E. The State Board of Education shall adopt and amend
8 regulations regarding the classification, definition, and financial
9 administration of funds, accounts, and expenditures in accordance
10 with the requirements of this section.

11 F. A school district shall be authorized to make capital
12 expenditures from the general fund to defray the cost of rebuilding
13 a school building only if a school building or facility has been
14 destroyed by a fire or natural disaster, such as flood, tornado, or
15 other act of God, or by an act of a public enemy of the United
16 States or this state and monies received by the district through
17 insurance coverage, federal reimbursement, contributions, and
18 allocation from the State Board of Education from the State Public
19 Common School Building Equalization Fund are insufficient to rebuild
20 the facility. Capital expenditures from the general fund pursuant
21 to this subsection shall be limited to an amount necessary to defray
22 the cost of rebuilding the facility which exceeds monies received by
23 the school district through insurance, federal reimbursement,
24 contributions, and state allocations.

1 G. Schools which receive gifts, donations, or state-
2 appropriated monies for the purpose of capital expenditures or
3 projects shall place such monies in the building fund, as provided
4 by Section 1-118 of this title, and not in the general fund. School
5 districts which receive gifts, grants, or donations of monies for
6 noncapital expenditures may place the monies in the general fund,
7 and such monies shall not be required to be used during the year in
8 which the money was received but may accumulate from year to year
9 and shall not be considered a part of the general fund collections
10 until after one (1) year following the year in which the monies were
11 received when calculating the general fund carryover as provided for
12 in subsection G of Section 18-200.1 of this title.

13 H. School districts which receive monies from rental, sale, or
14 lease of buildings, impact aid monies, or grants, gifts, or
15 donations for capital purposes, whether from state, federal, or
16 other sources, may place such monies in the building fund authorized
17 by Section 1-118 of this title or the general fund authorized by
18 this section.

19 I. Any construction of a building included as a capital
20 expenditure from the general fund of a school district which is
21 authorized and has had a contractual agreement concerning such
22 construction executed prior to July 1, 1991, may be proceeded with
23 and completed as authorized prior to July 1, 1991, as a capital
24 expenditure from such general fund.

1 J. School districts receiving revenues authorized by Section 9B
2 of Article X of the Oklahoma Constitution shall be authorized to
3 make capital expenditures from the general revenue fund no greater
4 than the amount levied by the incentive millage.

5 K. Upon the approval of the State Board of Education, a school
6 district shall be authorized to make capital expenditures as defined
7 in this section from its general fund if:

8 1. A bond issue has been rejected at an election by the school
9 district electors voting on that question within the current school
10 year, as certified by the secretary of the county election board; or

11 2. The school district has voted indebtedness at any time
12 within the preceding three (3) school years through the issuance of
13 bonds or through approval by voters of issuance of new bonds for
14 more than eighty-five percent (85%) of the maximum allowable
15 pursuant to the provisions of Section 26 of Article X of the
16 Oklahoma Constitution as shown on the school district budget filed
17 with the State Board of Equalization for the current school year and
18 certifications by the Attorney General prior to April 1 of the
19 current school year. The State Board of Education shall establish
20 the rules to administer the provisions of this subsection which
21 shall include, but not be limited to, specification of a maximum
22 amount of general fund monies to be used for capital expenditures,
23 the purposes for which such funds may be expended, and the period of
24 time in which such funds shall be encumbered.

1 L. Other provisions of this section notwithstanding, a school
2 district shall be authorized to make capital expenditures from the
3 general fund if the total assessed property valuation per average
4 daily attendance is less than sixty percent (60%) of the state
5 average total assessed property valuation per average daily
6 attendance and if, for each year in which general fund revenue is
7 used for capital expenditures, the district has voted the five-mill
8 building fund levy authorized in Section 10 of Article X of the
9 Oklahoma Constitution and has voted indebtedness through the
10 issuance of new bonds for at least eighty-five percent (85%) within
11 the last three (3) years of the maximum allowable pursuant to the
12 provisions of Section 26 of Article X of the Oklahoma Constitution
13 as shown on the school district budget filed with the State Board of
14 Equalization for the current school year and certifications by the
15 Attorney General prior to April 1 of the school year. Provided, the
16 maximum amount of general fund revenue used for capital expenditures
17 pursuant to this subsection shall not exceed five percent (5%) of
18 the total yearly revenue to the general fund. Such fund may not be
19 used for capital expenditures for more than five (5) consecutive
20 years and may only be utilized for remodeling or construction of
21 classroom facilities and such ancillary facilities to such
22 classrooms as may be necessary. Provided, further, the
23 Superintendent of Public Instruction shall certify in writing, prior
24 to the expenditure of the funds for which provision is made in this

1 subsection, that such expenditures are in compliance with the
2 provisions of this subsection.

3 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

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